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Short-Term & Vacation Rental Discussions

Schlage Encode lock, interesting issue

Michael Baum  **POSTER**

 **#2 Short-Term & Vacation Rental Discussions Contributor**

Olympia, WA

Posted over 2 years ago

Hey everyone. I am just curious for those that have a Schlage Encode lock, have you seen it start going online and offline, especially during very cold weather.

The weather at the lakehouse had been in the -15 to -25 range for about a week or so and the lock would go on and offline every hour to 3 hours. Sometimes for 4 hours, sometimes for 15 minutes. Now that the temps are back up to the mid 20's to freezing it seems fine. I am guessing it was just the extreme low temps. Batteries are at 98% so that isn't the issue.

For those that have other smart locks, have you seen anything like that? The lock is connected to a Samsung SmartThings hub via Z-Wave.

I know that many here don't have to deal with such low temps in the winter, but ya never know!

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Sandra Kraus

Replied over 2 years ago

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YES!!!! I noticed that the weather is freezing the electronics or something funny like that.

I mentioned it to my husband today and glad we have back up keys to open the doors in case the electronic system malfunctions.

1 Vote

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Carolyn Fuller Cambridge, MA

Replied over 2 years ago

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I suspect that the issue is the SmartThings hub not the lock. Where do you have the hub physically located?

1 Vote

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Mark Miles Rental Property Investor Philadelphia, PA

Replied over 2 years ago

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710
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► Quote from [@Michael Baum](#):

Key question: what does off-line mean? Does it render the lock unusable? Or it simply can't connect to Wi-Fi in order to change passcodes? Because it shouldn't

require Wi-Fi to let people into the house, so as long as the lock is letting people in, it's mostly OK to deal with

Bottom line: in the freezing cold weather, is it simply that you can't remotely connect for a time period? Or the lock becomes totally unusable to houseguests?

⬆ 1 Vote

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Sandra Kraus
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YES!!!! I noticed that the weather is freezing the electronics or something funny like that.

I mentioned it to my husband today and glad we have back up keys to open the doors in case the electronic system malfunctions.

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Michael Baum **POSTER**

#2 Short-Term & Vacation Rental Discussions Contributor

Olympia, WA
Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

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► Quote from [@Carolyn Fuller](#):

The hub is about 20 feet away from the lock. I don't believe it is the hub as the other devices connect just fine.

⬆ 0 Votes

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Michael Baum **POSTER**

#2 Short-Term & Vacation Rental Discussions Contributor

Olympia, WA

Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

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► Quote from [@Mark Miles](#):

The SmartThings app reports the lock is offline. I can't communicate with it, change codes or even see the codes. I assume the lock works just fine to get in but I am 7 hours away and can't test it.

Right now the temps are 30 degrees and the lock is online no problems. It has been available for about 3 days or so once the temps got above zero.

0 Votes

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Carolyn Fuller Cambridge, MA

Replied over 2 years ago

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Michael, Then you are probably right that the lock is the issue. Hopefully, the guests are able to unlock & lock the door despite the cold. Those are quite the temps!

0 Votes

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Sandra Kraus

Replied over 2 years ago

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Agree, with Michael it's the lock since it's exposed to the exterior temperature and not the hub.

0 Votes

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Nathan M kiefer Rental Property Investor south carolina and michigan

Replied over 2 years ago

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226
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My experience is it's usually the WiFi. Temps will mess with the batteries but WiFi flux usually causes the problem

⬆️ 0 Votes

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Leon Lee Real Estate Investor Atlanta, GA
Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

286
Posts

67
Votes

► Quote from [@Michael Baum](#):

Is this an old model? I don't remember newer Schlage "Encode" Lock requires hubs, but Schlage Connect does. I used to use some Schlage Connect locks that uses z-wave technology and requires Smartthing hub, but quickly found that one more device means one more hassle. Some guests simply unplug it when they need to charge their phone, as they don't see how their stay is disrupted by removing the hub.

⬆️ 0 Votes

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Michael Baum ✍️ **POSTER** 🏆 #2 Short-Term & Vacation Rental Discussions Contributor
Olympia, WA
Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

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Hey [@Leon Lee](#). It is a Schlage Connect. That is my fault. Got the wrong one.

I haven't had any issues with the SmartThings hub.

The big advantage of the Z Wave is battery life vs WiFi.

⬆️ 0 Votes

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Jeremy Jarecky Real Estate Agent Salt Lake City, UT
Replied over 2 years ago

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Hey Michael! Totally have the same issue with my Schlage and August/Yale locks. It doesn't accurately display the current lock condition and goes on/off line every few hours. The cold weather tends to drain the battery for me as well

⬆️ 1 Vote

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JD Martin

Rock Star Extraordinaire Northeast, TN

MODERATOR Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

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Posts

► Quote from [@Michael Baum](#):

16,683
Votes

I only have this lock at my Florida house so I can't provide anything of value regarding low temperatures. I haven't had any problems at higher temperatures, but the lock itself is inside an air conditioned property. I would think that if the inside of your house is heated you shouldn't have any problems, as that is where the batteries and everything of importance is located.

JD Martin Podcast Guest on Show #243



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Corina Eufinger

Rental Property Investor Oconomowoc, WI

Replied over 2 years ago

User Stats

982
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423
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Bitter cold temps can affect the performance of "electrical" based locks. Most of them are rated to survive in double digits, but when you to singles and negative it gets dicey real quick.

⬆️ 1 Vote

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Suzanne McQuaid

Replied almost 2 years ago

User Stats

1
Posts

0
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I've been having this issue as well, with both the encode and the encode plus. Currently, I am in Greece on vacation and my encode plus is off-line. Last time this happened I was going out of town and it made my lock not functional and I had guests and I had to cancel all of my plans. For this cost, \$350 for the plus, I am extremely disappointed. So once again it's off-line and I have guest that just checked in and I'm keeping my fingers crossed that they can hang in there until I get home in two days. Temps are in the 90s.

⬆️ 0 Votes

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